

1770



An engraving depicting the violence of the Boston Massacre.

AFTER THE FAILURE OF THE STAMP ACT (see 1765) the British government was still left with the question of how to raise money in the colonies. The answer came in a series of acts formulated by the Chancellor of the Exchequer, **Charles Townshend** (1725–67). The legislation included duties on paint, paper, glass, lead, and tea imported to the American colonies, as well as a reorganization of customs to cut down on smuggling. In addition, another act suspended the New York legislature because it refused to comply with the **Quartering Act**, which demanded that colonial assemblies provide basic necessities for British soldiers in the territories. On March 5, a group of dock workers began to



Marie Antoinette miniature
A cameo of Marie Antoinette, who would become one of the most infamous queens of France.

harass some British soldiers on patrol near a customs house in Boston, and a crowd formed. More soldiers arrived and opened fire on the colonists—the majority of whom were unarmed—killing five and wounding a further six. This episode became known as the **Boston Massacre** and fuelled resentment between Britain and its American colonies.

In Europe, the Dauphin of France, the future **Louis XVI** (1754–93), married the daughter of Maria Theresa of Austria, **Marie Antoinette**. They were 15 and 14 years old, respectively, at the time.

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THE AGE AT WHICH MARIE ANTOINETTE MARRIED LOUIS XVI

1771



The Cromford Mill set up by Richard Arkwright in Derbyshire.

THE BIRTH OF THE INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION came a step closer when Englishman **Richard Arkwright** (1732–92) worked with clockmaker John Kay to develop a **spinning frame**. By 1771 they had decided to use a waterwheel to power it—hence the name “**water frame**” and built a factory—Cromford Mill—in northern England, making this the first **water-powered textile mill**. The venture was a success and the textile factories became profitable, leading Arkwright to open a series of factories in England and Scotland.

Arkwright's inventions are considered an important part of the **Industrial Revolution**, which transformed Britain from an agricultural economy to a manufacturing one. The mills saw the development of the **mass-production** factory system which would be adopted all over the world.

INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION

The Industrial Revolution was an economic transformation that took place in Europe during the late 18th and early 19th centuries, changing rural, agrarian economies to ones based on manufactured goods, which were often made in cities. This transformation began in England, and was facilitated by the arrival of inventions such as the spinning jenny (see 1765) and the use of steam power (see 1775), which led to the growth of industries such as textiles in cities like Manchester. New technologies soon spread throughout Europe, and other countries such as France, Germany, and Belgium were seeing similar economic shifts as agricultural workers left the countryside for jobs in growing urban centers, or to work in the coal mines that powered the urban factories.

1772



An engraving showing the assassination of Gustavus III of Sweden (bottom), whose constitution and reforms angered the nobility and led to his death.



POLAND FACED the first of three **partitions** of its territory. This resulted from **Russia's defeats of the Ottoman Turks** in the Russo-Turkish War (see 1768), which had alarmed **Austria** and **Prussia**. Frederick II aimed to shift Russian expansion from Turkish territory to the Polish-Lithuanian Union, which was weakened by civil war. On August 5, Russia, Prussia, and Austria signed a **treaty**—ratified

by the Polish legislature (Sejm)—depriving Poland of a third of its land, of which all three powers took a share.

In Sweden, **Gustavus III** (1746–92) took the throne, though the monarchy had been weakened by a government faction wishing to limit the Crown's power. In response, Gustavus staged a coup and issued a new constitution. He introduced judicial reforms and strengthened Sweden's navy. However, he was unpopular with the nobility, of whom he was critical, and was denounced for his expenditure of public funds. He was assassinated in 1792.

In England, a legal case was mounted over a slave, **James Somerset**, who had been brought from Jamaica to England in 1771 and was due to be sent back. The Lord Chief Justice, Lord Mansfield, ruled Somerset must be freed. This set a precedent that people could not be taken out of England against their will.

April 19 Marriage of France's Louis XVI (1754–93) to Marie Antoinette (1755–93)

April 29 Captain Cook arrives at Botany Bay, Australia

Belgian inventor **John-Joseph Merlin** (1735–1803) develops forerunner of modern wheelchair

July 5–7 Russians beat Turks at naval Battle of Chesma

July 12 English carpenter and weaver **James Hargreaves** (1720–78) patents the spinning jenny, which he invented in 1765

Richard Arkwright sets up the first water-powered mill in Derbyshire, England

October 17 Mozart premieres his opera, *Ascanio* in Alba, aged 15

February 12 Gustavus III (1746–92) of Sweden reestablishes absolute monarchy

June 22 The decision delivered in the trial known as **Somerset's case** leads to abolition of slavery within Britain

August 5 First partition of Poland by Austria, Prussia, and Russia

Captain Cook leaves on his second voyage, after a brief return to Britain